



WESTERN SIBERIA IS A COLD, WILD PLACE with few habitable areas.

NENETS

LIFE AT THE END OF THE EARTH

One group of people who live there and survive the harsh conditions are the Nenets. Certain Nenets groups are entirely nomadic, traveling with

The reindeer

The Nenets people's lives revolve around reindeer. They could not live without the animal—the fur is used for clothing and houses, ropes are made from the hide, the reindeer are used as transportation and, of course, as food. For this reason they take great care of these hardy animals, watching over them each night and looking after the ill ones. They maintain a close relationship with one another.



CROSSING RIVERS

To help them walk over snow, reindeer have large, splayed feet, which make very efficient paddles as well. They can swim at 10 mph (15 kmph) and at this speed the sleds they pull through the water remain dry and above the waterline.



STAPLE DIET

The Nenets eat mainly meat, fish, and some bread but reindeer meat is the staple diet. The meat is sometimes cooked, but often eaten raw. When a reindeer is killed, everyone gathers around to drink the warm blood, which is rich in vitamins and minerals.



MODERN LIVING

Some Nenets are completely nomadic, setting up their camp where the reindeer migrate. For this reason, modern children are sent to boarding schools in order to gain an education. The Nenets are eager that they return to continue the traditional way of life.



ARCTIC CLOTHING

Everything that the Nenets wear is made from reindeer skin – from coats to boots. *Yagushka* are women's double-layered reindeer coats that have the fur facing inside and out. The skins are incredibly warm and windproof. Baby reindeer skins are used for baby clothes, and wood shavings are used as baby nappies.